



SELF CREDIT REPAIR VAULT

The Complete DIY System for Disputing
Errors, Negotiating Deletions & Rebuilding
Your Credit Score — Using Federal Law

MODULE 1 · Know Your File

MODULE 2 · Dispute Letters (FCRA § 611)

MODULE 3 · Certified Mail Protocol

MODULE 4 · Response Tracker

MODULE 5 · Method of Verification Follow-Up

MODULE 6 · Goodwill & Pay-for-Delete Scripts

FCRA-BACKED · NO MONTHLY FEES · NO MIDDLEMAN

What's Inside

MODULE	TITLE	PURPOSE
1	Know Your File	Pull & audit all 3 credit reports
2	Dispute Letters	FCRA § 611 — send legally grounded disputes
3	Certified Mail Protocol	Create a paper trail that holds up
4	Response Tracker	Log everything — violations = money
5	Method of Verification	Force bureaus to prove their data
6	Goodwill & Pay-for-Delete	Negotiate accurate items off your report
APPENDIX	CROA Notice + Legal Glossary	Know your rights & terms

How to use this vault: Work through each module in order. Each one builds on the last. Don't skip Module 1 — knowing exactly what's on your reports is the foundation of everything that follows.

MODULE 1

Know Your File

Pull your reports · Identify errors · Prioritize targets

Step 1 — Pull All Three Reports

The three major credit bureaus — **Equifax, Experian, and TransUnion** — maintain separate files on you. They do not automatically share corrected data. You must dispute with each bureau individually.

Official Source: AnnualCreditReport.com is the only federally mandated free report site (FCRA § 612). Pull all three at once. You are entitled to one free report per bureau per year — and currently weekly free reports are available through 2026.

Step 2 — What to Look For

CATEGORY	WHAT TO CHECK	DISPUTABLE IF...
Personal Info	Name, address, SSN, DOB	Wrong spelling, old addresses listed as current
Accounts	Balance, status, payment history	Wrong balance, closed shown as open, not yours
Collections	Collector name, original creditor, amount	Amount wrong, already paid, past 7-year limit
Inquiries	Hard vs. soft, dates, companies	Hard inquiry you never authorized
Public Records	Bankruptcies, judgments	Older than 7–10 years, wrong court, not yours

Step 3 — Build Your Priority List

Not all negative items hit your score equally. Prioritize your disputes in this order:

1st	Items that are factually wrong Strongest legal ground — bureaus must delete if unverifiable
2nd	Collections past the 7-year clock Should have auto-dropped — if not, demand deletion
3rd	Unauthorized hard inquiries Each one costs ~5 points; you did not consent
4th	Accurate negative items Goodwill or pay-for-delete route — see Module 6

MODULE 2

Dispute Letters

FCRA § 611 — The legal basis for every dispute you send

Your Rights Under FCRA § 611

Under the Fair Credit Reporting Act (15 U.S.C. § 1681i), credit bureaus must: (1) Investigate your dispute within **30 days** of receipt (45 days if submitted after pulling your free annual report); (2) Contact the furnisher of the disputed information; (3) Delete or correct any item that cannot be verified; (4) Provide you written results of the investigation.

Important: What 'Dispute' Actually Means

A dispute is a formal assertion that information on your report is **inaccurate, incomplete, or unverifiable**. The bureau's obligation is to verify — not merely re-confirm — the disputed item. If they cannot verify it with the original furnisher, they must delete it. Your job is to make verification difficult by being specific and documented.

Letter Template A — Collection Account Dispute

[Your Full Legal Name]

[Your Address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Date]

Dispute Department

[Equifax / Experian / TransUnion]

[Bureau Mailing Address]

Re: Formal Dispute of Collection Account — FCRA § 611

Account/Reference #: [Account Number as it appears on report]

Original Creditor: [Name if known]

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing to formally dispute the above-referenced collection account appearing on my credit report. I am exercising my rights under the Fair Credit Reporting Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1681i.

The basis for my dispute is as follows: [Select applicable]

■ This account does not belong to me.

■ The balance reported (\$_____) is incorrect. Correct balance: \$_____

■ This account was paid in full on [date]. Confirmation #: [if available]

■ The date of first delinquency is more than 7 years ago. (FCRA § 1681c)

■ Other: _____

Pursuant to FCRA § 611(a)(1), I request that you conduct a reasonable investigation and, if the information cannot be verified, delete this item from my credit file within 30 days of receiving this letter.

I am also requesting, per FCRA § 611(a)(7), the method of verification used should this item be confirmed. Please provide the name, address, and telephone number of any person contacted in connection with your investigation.

Enclosed: [List any supporting documents — e.g., payment confirmation, identity documents]

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]

[Your Full Printed Name]

[Date]

Sent via USPS Certified Mail — Tracking #: _____

Letter Template B — Late Payment Dispute

[Your Full Legal Name]

[Your Address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Date]

Dispute Department

[Bureau Name & Address]

Re: Formal Dispute of Late Payment Notation — FCRA § 611

Creditor: [Name] Account #: [Last 4 or as shown] Date of Alleged Late Payment: [Month/Year]

To Whom It May Concern:

I am disputing the late payment notation referenced above, which I believe is inaccurate. Under FCRA § 1681s-2(b), furnishers of credit information are required to provide accurate data. This notation does not accurately reflect my payment history for the following reason:

- Payment was made on time. [Attach bank statement or payment confirmation]
- I was on an approved hardship/deferment plan during this period.
- The creditor applied payment to the wrong cycle.
- Other: _____

I request investigation and correction or deletion of this notation within 30 days per FCRA § 611(a)(1)(A).

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] | [Your Name] | [Date]

Sent via USPS Certified Mail — Tracking #: _____

Letter Template C — Unauthorized Hard Inquiry

[Your Full Legal Name] · [Address] · [Date]

Dispute Department — [Bureau Name & Address]

Re: Demand for Removal of Unauthorized Hard Inquiry

Inquiring Company: [Name] Date of Inquiry: [Date]

To Whom It May Concern:

A hard inquiry from [Company Name] dated [Date] appears on my credit report. I did not authorize this inquiry and have no record of initiating a credit application with this company.

Under FCRA § 1681b, a consumer reporting agency may only furnish a report for a hard inquiry when the consumer has given written authorization. I did not provide such authorization.

I demand this inquiry be removed from my file immediately. If you maintain that this inquiry was permissible, please provide — within 30 days — the written authorization you have on file bearing my signature.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] | [Your Name] | [Date]

Sent via USPS Certified Mail — Tracking #: _____

MODULE 3

Certified Mail Protocol

No proof of receipt = no legal leverage. This step is non-negotiable.

Why Certified Mail Is the Foundation of This Entire System

If a bureau or collector claims they never received your dispute, your entire case collapses. Certified Mail with Return Receipt creates a federal paper trail that is admissible evidence. It also starts the 30-day investigation clock the moment the USPS confirms delivery.

STEP 1**Print Your Letter**

Print a clean copy. Sign in ink. Keep a photocopy for your records before sealing.

STEP 2**Prepare the Envelope**

Address to the bureau's official dispute mailing address (not the generic address on their website — use the one printed on your credit report).

STEP 3**Visit USPS**

Request 'Certified Mail with Return Receipt' (Form PS 3811 — the green card). Cost: ~\$8–\$9 per letter. Worth every cent.

STEP 4**Record the Tracking Number**

Write it in your Response Tracker (Module 4) immediately. This is your evidence.

STEP 5**Wait for the Green Card**

When signed and returned, the green card is proof of delivery. File it with your letter copy. If the bureau loses your dispute, this card proves they received it.

STEP 6**Note the Delivery Date**

The 30-day investigation window begins on the date of confirmed delivery — not the date you mailed it. Track this date in your Response Tracker.

Official Bureau Dispute Mailing Addresses:

- Equifax: P.O. Box 740256, Atlanta, GA 30374
- Experian: P.O. Box 4500, Allen, TX 75013
- TransUnion: Consumer Dispute Center, P.O. Box 2000, Chester, PA 19016

MODULE 4

Response Tracker

Log every dispute. Track every deadline. Violations = your leverage.

The bureaus have 30 days to respond. If they don't, that is an FCRA violation and grounds for a lawsuit or CFPB complaint. Log everything.

Dispute Log

Bureau	Item Disputed	Certified Mail #	Mailed Date	Delivery Date	30-Day Deadline	Response Received	Outcome

Outcome Key

Code	Meaning	Next Action
DELETED	Item removed from report	Pull new report in 30 days to confirm
UPDATED	Information corrected	Verify the correction is accurate
VERIFIED	Bureau claims item is accurate	Proceed to Module 5 (Method of Verification)
NO RESPONSE	Bureau did not reply in 30 days	File CFPB complaint immediately
PARTIAL	Some but not all items corrected	Re-dispute remaining items

CFPB Complaint: If a bureau fails to investigate or respond within 30 days, file a complaint at consumerfinance.gov/complaint. CFPB complaints create a federal record and typically trigger a faster response than a second dispute letter. You can also file with your state Attorney General.

MODULE 5

Method of Verification

FCRA § 611(a)(7) — Force them to prove how they verified your data

When a bureau responds to your dispute with 'Verified,' your next move is to demand the method of verification. This is a legally distinct follow-up — not a re-dispute — and carries its own 15-day response requirement.

The Legal Basis: FCRA § 611(a)(7) states that if a consumer requests the method of verification within 15 days of receiving the investigation results, the bureau must provide: (A) the business name and address of any furnisher contacted, and (B) the telephone number if reasonably available.

Method of Verification Letter

[Your Full Legal Name]
[Your Address]
[City, State, ZIP]
[Date — must be within 15 days of receiving 'Verified' response]

Dispute Department
[Bureau Name & Address]

Re: Request for Method of Verification — FCRA § 611(a)(7)
Original Dispute Reference: [Your previous certified mail tracking number]
Item in Question: [Exact item as it appears on report]

To Whom It May Concern:

On [date], I received your investigation results indicating the above-referenced item was 'verified.' Pursuant to the Fair Credit Reporting Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1681i(a)(7), I hereby request within 15 days of this letter:

1. The name, address, and telephone number of each person contacted in connection with your investigation of my dispute.
2. The specific method used to verify the accuracy of the disputed information, including any documentation reviewed.

If you are unable to provide this information, or if the furnisher confirms that the information is inaccurate, this item must be deleted from my credit file immediately.

Please be advised that failure to comply with this request is itself a violation of the FCRA, for which I reserve all legal remedies.

Sincerely,
[Your Signature] | [Your Name] | [Date]
Sent via USPS Certified Mail — Tracking #: _____

If They Still Can't Verify

If the bureau cannot produce the method of verification, the item must be deleted. If they still refuse, you now have documented FCRA violations. Your options:

CFPB Complaint	File at consumerfinance.gov/complaint . Attach your certified mail receipts and the bureau's responses. CFPB action often produces faster results than additional letters.
FTC Report	File at reportfraud.ftc.gov . Creates a federal record of the violation.
Attorney Consultation	FCRA violations entitle you to actual damages, statutory damages up to \$1,000 per violation, and attorney's fees. Many consumer rights attorneys take these on contingency.
State AG Complaint	File with your state Attorney General — Texas AG at texasattorneygeneral.gov .

MODULE 6

Goodwill & Pay-for-Delete

Negotiating accurate negative items off your report

Modules 2–5 address inaccurate or unverifiable items. This module handles **accurate negative items** — late pays, charge-offs, or collections that really happened but that you want removed. Two tools exist: the Goodwill Letter and the Pay-for-Delete negotiation.

Important Distinction: Creditors are NOT legally required to agree to goodwill removal or pay-for-delete. These are negotiations, not rights. Success rates vary. The older the item and the better your current standing with the creditor, the higher your odds.

Tool A — The Goodwill Letter

Best for: A single late payment on an otherwise solid account with a creditor you still have a relationship with. Appeal to human discretion — not legal rights.

[Your Full Legal Name] · [Address] · [Date]

Customer Relations Department
[Original Creditor Name & Address]

Re: Goodwill Adjustment Request — Account #[XXXX]

Dear [Creditor Name] Customer Relations Team,

I am writing to respectfully request a goodwill adjustment to the late payment notation reported to the credit bureaus for my account referenced above, dated [Month/Year].

I have been a customer since [year] and my overall payment history reflects my commitment to this account. The late payment in question occurred due to [brief, honest explanation — e.g., unexpected medical expense, job transition, banking error]. This is not representative of my typical behavior.

I understand this reporting is accurate and I am not disputing it. I am simply asking — as a matter of goodwill — whether you would consider removing this notation as a gesture of customer goodwill given my otherwise positive history.

I would be deeply grateful for any consideration. If helpful, I am happy to provide documentation of the circumstances.

Respectfully,
[Your Signature] | [Your Name] | [Date]
Preferred contact: [Phone] or [Email]

Tool B — Pay-for-Delete Negotiation

Best for: Unpaid or settled collections that still appear active. You offer payment (or a lump sum settlement) in exchange for complete deletion from your credit report.

Before You Offer	Verify the debt is within the statute of limitations for your state. In Texas, written contracts are 4 years. Do not make a payment on a time-barred debt — it can reset the clock.
Start Low	If the collection is for \$1,000, offer 40–50% to start. Collectors often bought the debt for pennies on the dollar. They have room.
Demand Written Agreement First	Never pay before receiving written confirmation that payment = deletion. A verbal promise is worthless. Get it on their letterhead.
What the Letter Must Say	'Upon receipt of agreed payment of \$[amount], [Collector Name] agrees to request deletion of account #[XXXX] from all three major credit bureaus within 30 days.'
After Payment	Pull your reports 30–45 days after payment to confirm deletion. If it still appears, you have a breach of contract claim.

Appendix

A — Legal Glossary

FCRA	<i>Fair Credit Reporting Act (15 U.S.C. § 1681 et seq.)</i> The federal law governing how credit bureaus collect, store, and use your data.
CROA	<i>Credit Repair Organizations Act (15 U.S.C. § 1679)</i> Governs companies that charge for credit repair services.
CFPB	<i>Consumer Financial Protection Bureau</i> Federal agency that enforces consumer financial laws and accepts complaints.
Furnisher	<i>Any company that reports your payment info to bureaus</i> Banks, lenders, collection agencies, landlords (sometimes).
Hard Inquiry	<i>Credit check triggered by a credit application</i> Stays on report 2 years; can lower score ~5 pts each.
Soft Inquiry	<i>Background/pre-approval check</i> Does NOT affect score; not visible to lenders.
Statute of Limitations	<i>Time limit for a creditor to sue you for a debt</i> Varies by state. Texas: 4 years for written contracts.
7-Year Rule	<i>FCRA § 1681c — most negative items must be removed after 7 years</i> Calculated from date of first delinquency, not last activity.
Pay-for-Delete	<i>Negotiated agreement: payment in exchange for deletion</i> Not legally required; must be in writing before you pay.
Goodwill Deletion	<i>Creditor voluntarily removes accurate negative item</i> Discretionary; no legal right; works best with good overall history.

B — CROA Required Disclosure

Notice Required by the Credit Repair Organizations Act (15 U.S.C. § 1679c):

You have a right to dispute inaccurate information in your credit report by contacting the credit bureau directly. There is no fee or charge for this. Any improvements to your credit report from the use of a credit repair company may also be made without the use of such a company. You have a right to cancel your contract with any credit repair organization for any reason within 3 business days from the date you signed it. Credit bureaus are required to follow reasonable procedures to ensure maximum possible accuracy of the information they report about you.

This vault is an **educational resource**. It does not constitute legal advice. The letters and frameworks provided are templates — not professional legal services. For complex situations, consult a licensed consumer law attorney.

C — Key Resources

Resource	Purpose
AnnualCreditReport.com	Pull all 3 free credit reports (federally mandated)
consumerfinance.gov/complaint	File CFPB complaints against bureaus or collectors
reportfraud.ftc.gov	File FTC reports for FCRA violations
nclc.org	National Consumer Law Center — free resources and attorney referrals
texasattorneygeneral.gov	Texas AG consumer complaint portal
consumeradvocates.org	Find a consumer rights attorney near you